

Ring Homomorphism $\pi : R \rightarrow R/I$

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Observation. In the ring of integers $\mathbb{Z}$, there are three ideals containing $4\mathbb{Z}$:

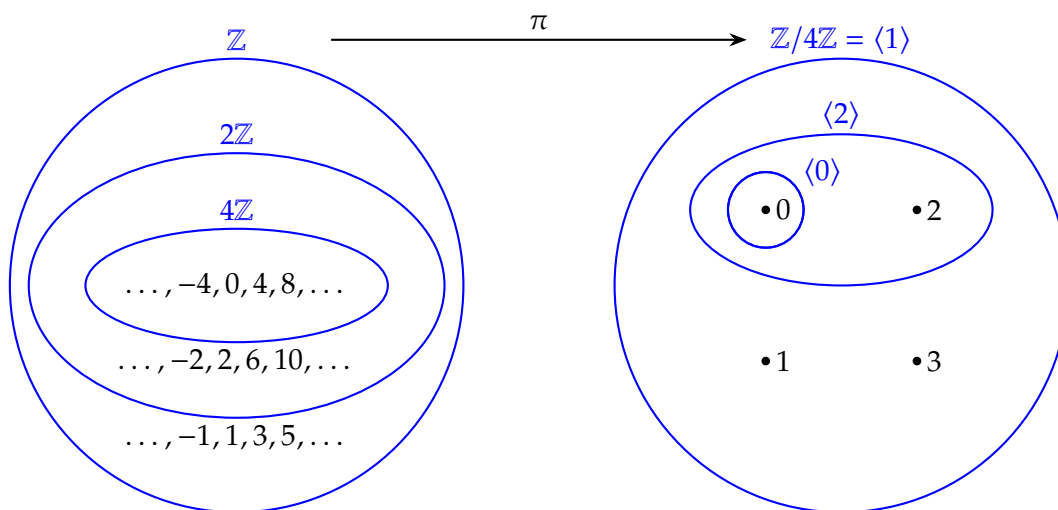
$$4\mathbb{Z} \subset 2\mathbb{Z} \subset \mathbb{Z}.$$

In the ring $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$, there are three ideals total:

$$\langle 0 \rangle = \{0 \cdot x : x \in \mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}\} = \{0\},$$

$$\langle 1 \rangle = \{1 \cdot x : x \in \mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}\} = \{0, 1, 2, 3\} = \langle 3 \rangle \text{ and}$$

$$\langle 2 \rangle = \{2 \cdot x : x \in \mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}\} = \{0, 2\}.$$



Here, there is a bijection $\{4\mathbb{Z}, 2\mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Z}\} \rightarrow \{\langle 0 \rangle, \langle 1 \rangle, \langle 2 \rangle\}$.

- Let R be a ring, and $I \subseteq R$ be an ideal.
- We write “ $I \triangleleft R$ ” to indicate that I is an ideal of R .
- The natural projection map is

$$\begin{aligned}\pi : R &\longrightarrow R/I \\ r &\longmapsto r + I\end{aligned}$$

for all $r \in R$.

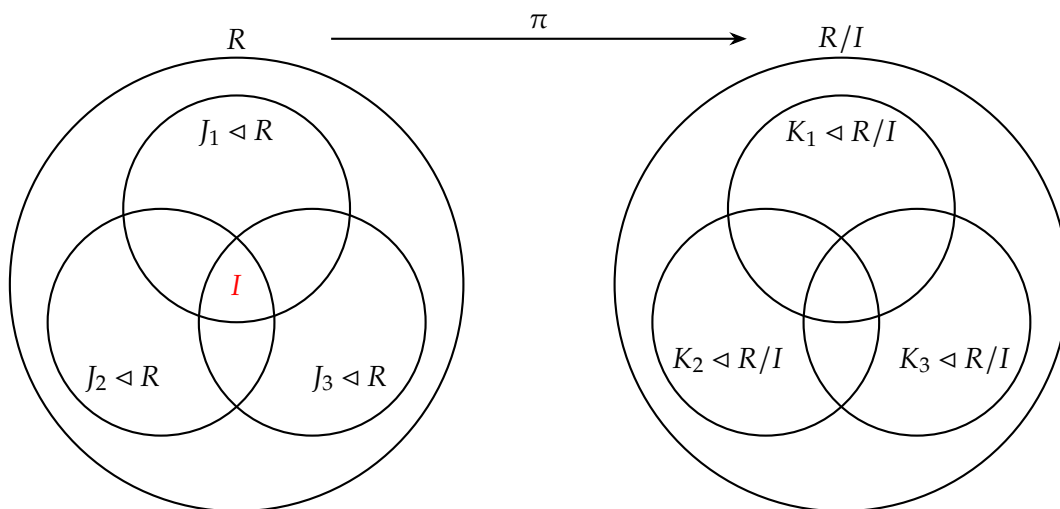
- Let

$$\mathcal{L}_I(R) := \{J \subseteq R : I \subseteq J \text{ and } J \triangleleft R\}$$

is the set of ideals of R that contain I , and let

$$\mathcal{L}(R/I) := \{K \subseteq R/I : K \triangleleft R/I\}$$

is the set of ideals of the quotient ring R/I .



Theorem. There is a one-to-one correspondence between the set of ideals of R containing I and the set of ideals of R/I . That is, there is a bijection

$$\phi : \mathcal{L}_I(R) \rightarrow \mathcal{L}(R/I).$$

Proof. Consider

$$\begin{aligned}\phi : \mathcal{L}_I(R) &\longrightarrow \mathcal{L}(R/I) \\ J &\longmapsto J/I\end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned}\psi &: \mathcal{L}(R/I) \longrightarrow \mathcal{L}_I(R) \\ K &\longmapsto \pi^{-1}[K] = \{r \in R : r + I \in K\}.\end{aligned}$$

We must show that

- $\psi[\phi[J]] = J$ for all $J \subseteq R$ s.t. $I \subseteq J$;
- $\phi[\psi[K]] = K$ for all $K \subseteq R/I$.

(i) Let $J \in \mathcal{L}_I(R)$, i.e., $I \subseteq J \subseteq R$ and $J \triangleleft R$. Then

$$\phi[J] = J/I = \{r + I : r \in J\},$$

and so

$$\begin{aligned}\psi[\phi[J]] &= \psi[J/I] \\ &= \{r \in R : r + I \in J/I\}, \\ &= \{r \in R : r \in J\}, \\ &= J.\end{aligned}$$

(ii) Let $K \in \mathcal{L}(R/I)$, i.e., $K \subseteq R/I$ and $K \triangleleft R/I$. Then

$$\psi[K] = \pi^{-1}[K] = \{r \in R : r + I \in K\},$$

and so

$$\begin{aligned}\phi[\psi[K]] &= \phi[\pi^{-1}[K]] \\ &= \{r + I : r + \pi^{-1}[K]\}, \\ &= \{r + I : r + I \in K\}, \\ &= K.\end{aligned}$$

□